

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

National TT: Manav, Yashaswini bag maiden crowns



Manav Thakkar and Yashaswini Ghorpade, both representing the Petroleum Sports Promotion Board (PSPB), clinched their maiden men's and women's singles titles at the 87th Senior National Table Tennis Championship in Indore.

Even before the finals began at the Abhay Prashal Indoor Stadium, it was clear that new national champions would be crowned in both categories. Top seed Manav lived up to expectations, halting 15th seed Jeet Chandra's impressive run in the men's singles final. Moments earlier, eighth seed Yashaswini edged past third seed Syndrela Das in a gripping all-PSPB women's final.

Manav's consistency proved too strong for Jeet in a contest between two bespectacled paddlers.

The women's final, in contrast, was a fluctuating contest. Yashaswini relied on her control, particularly with her long-pimpled backhand, while 16-year-old Syndrela showcased her attacking prowess with powerful backhand winners, repeatedly staging comebacks.

Earlier, Syndrela had upset defending champion Diya Chitale in a tense semifinal, while Yashaswini progressed comfortably past Suhana Saini.

Along with the trophies and medals, both Manav and Yashaswini received prize money of ₹3.52 lakh each, while runners-up Jeet and Syndrela earned ₹1.76 lakh apiece.

AMOL KARHADKAR



Yashaswini Ghorpade and Manav Thakkar pose with their respective trophies after bagging their maiden National TT crowns. AMOL KARHADKAR

SPORTOON

